



Specifications

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Manufacturer	Dealer	Phone	E-mail	Price	Max. Resolution (Optical)	Max. Resolution (Interpolated)	Light source	Scanning element
AceR ScanPrisa 640BU	Acer Peripherals	022-5705230	pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw	Rs 6,700	600x1200	19200x19200	Cold cathode fluorescent	CCD
AceR ScanPrisa 640U	Acer Peripherals	022-5705230	pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw	Rs 5,500	600x1200	19200x19200	Cold cathode fluorescent	CCD
AceR ScanPrisa 1240UT	Acer Peripherals	022-5705230	pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw	Rs 16,000	600x1200	19200x19200	Cold cathode fluorescent	CCD
Epson 1240U Photo	Epson India Ltd	080-5321266-70	sheetal@eid.epson.co.in	Rs 19,500	1200x2400	9600x9600	White cold cathode fluorescent lamp	ColorMatrixCCD line sensor
Epson 1640SU	Epson India Ltd	080-5321266-70	sheetal@eid.epson.co.in	Rs 22,500	1600x3200	12800x12800	White cold cathode fluorescent lamp	Color MatrixCCD line sensor
HP Scanjet 5300C	Hewlett Packard (I) Ltd	011-6826000	princy_bhatnagar@hp.com	Rs 12,499	1200x2400	9600x9600	Dual cold-cathode flourescent	CCD
HP Scanjet 6350C	Hewlett Packard India Ltd	011-6826000	princy_bhatnagar@hp.com	Rs 26,499	1200x2400	999,999	Dual cold-cathode flourescent	CCD
MICROTEK Scanmaker 3600	Microtek International Ltd.	491 3986/87/88/89/90	info@compuageindia.com	Rs 4,550	600x1200	9600x9600	Cathode fluorescent lamp	CCD
MICROTEK Scanmaker X6	Microtek International Ltd.	491 3986/87/88/89/90	info@compuageindia.com	Rs 7,250	600x1200	9600x9600	Cathode fluorescent lamp	CCD
Mustek 1200CUB	Integra Micro Systems Pvt. Ltd.	8207208/8215179	mumbai@integramicro.com	Rs 9,000	600x1200	19200x19200	Cathode fluorescent lamp	CCD
UMAX Astra 3400	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 5,550	600x1200	9600x9600	Cold cathode lamp	CCD
UMAX Astra 3450	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 9,950	600x1200	9600x9600	Cold cathode lamp	CCD
UMAX Astra 2000p	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 3,900	600x1200	9600x9600	Cold cathode lamp Cold cathode lamp	CCD
UMAX Astra 2400S	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 18,000	600x2400	9600x9600		CCD
UMAX Astra 4000U	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 17,000	1200x2400	9600x9600	Cold cathode lamp	CCD
UMAX iA101	Neoteric Infomatique	022-4172600	sales@neoteric-info.com	Rs 6,500	600x1200	9600x9600	Cold cathode lamp	CCD

An Eye for Detail

The feature to look out for in scanners is resolution. Basically, this means the optical resolution, or the information the scanner has actually acquired, and the interpolated resolution, which is the resolution attained after applying several enhancements to the image. If you are looking for greater detail in the document/picture, then you should go in for a scanner with a higher optical resolution. However, if you just want to enlarge the photos, then a higher interpolated resolution is what you need.

For images with few details, an optical resolution of 300 dpi will be sufficient. But

for scanning line art and detailed images, you will need a scanner with an optical resolution of 600 dpi. Some film and slide scanners offer a resolution of 1200 dpi.

However, it is advisable not to scan at the maximum resolution your scanner supports because the quality of the image suffers when it is passed through an image editing software. Also bear in mind that quality at a given resolution differs in the case of scanners offering different maximum resolutions. For example, an image scanned at 300 dpi would look clearer if scanned from a 1200 dpi scanner than if scanned from a 300 dpi scanner.

Test photograph evaluation

This was a real-world test wherein we printed a full A4-sized photo in the highest quality mode using photo paper. Here, we looked out for the overall reproduction of the image and compared it with the original one in terms of colour reproduction, tones of the image and the hues in specific portions. A total of 11 results were logged in this test.

One scanner that really stood out in each of these 11 tests was the Epson Perfection 1640S.

The Umax Astra 4000U also performed impressively, but lost out in its reproduction of the finer details. The Microtek ScanMaker 3600 turned in the poorest results, and the ScanMaker X6 was also disappointing.